Databricks ML Associate
100 More Databricks-Specific Q&A (Q101–Q200)

Exam Blueprint Aligned

Q101 — Unity Catalog Governance for Models

A team needs fine-grained access control on registered models across workspaces. What should they use?

A. Workspace MLflow registry.
B. Unity Catalog model registry with catalog/schema/model grants.
C. A shared DBFS folder.
D. Notebook permissions only.

Correct: B.

UC grants apply at catalog, schema, and model level.

Workspace registry cannot enforce cross-workspace governance.

Q102 — MLflow Artifact Path

A run logs a large model artifact. Where is it stored by default in Databricks?

A. Driver local disk.
B. The experiment's artifact location (DBFS or cloud storage).
C. Notebook revision history.
D. The MLflow registry only.

A102 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

Each experiment defines an artifact location.

Registry stores metadata/lineage, not the raw artifact file.

Q103 — AutoML Generated Notebook

What can a data scientist do with the best-trial notebook AutoML generates?

A. Only view it read-only.
B. Open, edit, and re-run it to customize the pipeline.
C. Delete it permanently.
D. Convert it to SQL only.

A103 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

AutoML notebooks are editable starting points for production code.

Q104 — AutoML Evaluation Metric

How can a data scientist specify the metric AutoML optimizes?

A. `primary_metric` argument to `automl.regress()` / `automl.classify()`.
B. By deleting runs until the metric is right.
C. Metrics cannot be specified.
D. Only via UI.

Correct: A.

`primary_metric` controls the optimization target.

Q105 — MLflow Search Filter

Which expression filters runs by a logged metric in `search_runs`?

A. `metrics.accuracy > 0.9`.

B. `params.accuracy > 0.9`.

C. `tags.accuracy > 0.9`.

D. `artifacts.accuracy > 0.9`.

A105 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Metrics use the `metrics.` prefix; params use `params.`, tags use `tags.`.

Q106 — Feature Store Lookup Order

For point-in-time lookups, which two keys are required on a feature table?

A. Primary keys and timestamp keys.
B. Only primary keys.
C. Only timestamp keys.
D. Only a row ID.

A106 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Primary keys identify entities; timestamp keys define feature value timing.

Q107 — MLflow Model Loading by Alias

How is a model loaded by alias from the registry?

A. `mlflow.pyfunc.load_model("models:/my_model@champion")`.

B. `mlflow.log_model()`.

C. `mlflow.start_run()`.

D. `mlflow.get_run()`.

Correct: A.

The `models:/` URI with `@alias` resolves to the version the alias points to.

Q108 — Model Version URI

Which URI references a specific model version in MLflow?

A. `models:/my_model/3`.

B. `runs:/<run_id>/model`.

C. `models:/my_model@champion`.

D. `artifacts:/model`.

A108 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`models:/name/version` is a specific version; `@alias` is a moving pointer.

Q109 — Feature Engineering Write

Which method writes a DataFrame into a feature table?

A. `fe.write_table()`.

B. `df.write.saveAsTable()`.

C. `mlflow.log_artifact()`.

D. `spark.sql("INSERT")`.

A109 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`write_table()` registers data as a feature table with metadata.

Q110 — Serving Endpoint Update

How is a serving endpoint updated to a new model version?

A. Delete the endpoint.
B. Update the served entity config to point to a new version or alias.
C. Restart the cluster.
D. Create a new workspace.

A110 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

Endpoint config references version/alias; update config and the endpoint rolls to new model.

Q111 — Model Serving Provisioned Throughput

A high-traffic endpoint needs guaranteed capacity. What should be configured?

A. Scale to Zero only.
B. Provisioned throughput / dedicated capacity.
C. A larger driver only.
D. Fewer workers.

A111 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

Provisioned throughput reserves capacity; scale-to-zero is for occasional traffic.

Q112 — MLflow Log Model with Signature

How is a model logged with an input signature?

A. Pass `signature` to `mlflow.log_model()` or use `infer_signature()`.
B. Signatures are automatic only.
C. Use `log_metric()`.
D. Use `set_tag()`.

A112 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`mlflow.models.infer_signature()` + `log_model(signature=...)` records schema.

Q113 — Experiment Deletion

Which API call permanently deletes an MLflow experiment?

A. `client.delete_experiment()`.

B. `mlflow.end_run()`.

C. `client.delete_run()`.

D. `mlflow.set_experiment()`.

A113 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`delete_experiment()` marks the experiment deleted; `delete_run()` is for runs.

Q114 — MLflow Client Run Retrieval

Which call retrieves full run details using a run ID?

A. `client.get_run(run_id)`.

B. `client.search_runs()`.

C. `mlflow.start_run()`.

D. `mlflow.log_artifact()`.

A114 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`get_run()` returns a `Run` object with params, metrics, tags, artifacts.

Q115 — Model Registry Version Lineage

What links a UC model version to its training data?

A. The model signature.
B. UC lineage from the source run and experiment.
C. The cluster event log.
D. The endpoint config.

A115 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

UC records lineage from model version → run → inputs → tables used.

Q116 — Feature Store Time Series

Which key is used alongside primary keys in a time-series feature table?

A. `timestamp_keys`.

B. `row_id`.

C. `partition_col`.

D. `label_col`.

A116 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`create_table(timestamp_keys=...)` enables PIT joins.

Q117 — Serving Endpoint Logging Table

Where are request/response logs from an endpoint written when inference tables are enabled?

A. A Delta table.
B. A JSON file only.
C. The driver's stdout.
D. Notebook output.

A117 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Inference tables are Delta tables queryable for monitoring and retraining.

Q118 — Model Serving Auth

What mechanism authenticates calls to a Databricks serving endpoint?

A. A personal access token (PAT) or OAuth token.
B. No auth required.
C. The model version only.
D. A cluster token.

A118 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Endpoint requests use Databricks auth (PAT or OAuth M2M).

Q119 — MLflow Experiment Renaming

Which API renames an experiment?

A. `client.rename_experiment()`.

B. `mlflow.start_run()`.

C. `client.delete_experiment()`.

D. `mlflow.log_model()`.

A119 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`rename_experiment()` changes the experiment's name and path.

Q120 — Feature Store Serving Endpoint

An online feature table is used at inference. Which method retrieves features for a batch of entity IDs?

A. `fe.get_online_features()`.
B. `spark.read.table()` only.
C. `mlflow.load_model()`.
D. `dbutils.fs.head()`.

A120 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`get_online_features()` performs low-latency lookup from the online store.

Q121 — Spark ML Evaluator for Regression

Which evaluator with `CrossValidator` for regression?

A. `RegressionEvaluator`.
B. `BinaryClassificationEvaluator`.
C. `MulticlassClassificationEvaluator`.
D. `ClusteringEvaluator`.

A121 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`RegressionEvaluator` supports RMSE, MAE, R^2.

Q122 — Spark ML Logistic Regression

Which class trains binary logistic regression?

A. `LogisticRegression`.

B. `LinearRegression`.

C. `DecisionTreeClassifier`.

D. `RandomForestRegressor`.

A122 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q123 — Spark ML Linear Regression

Which class trains linear regression?

A. `LinearRegression`.

B. `LogisticRegression`.

C. `DecisionTreeClassifier`.

D. `NaiveBayes`.

A123 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q124 — Feature Importance Access

How is feature importance accessed for a tree-based model?

A. `model.featureImportances`.

B. `model.coefficients`.

C. `model.intercept`.

D. `model.summary`.

A124 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Tree models expose `featureImportances`; linear models use `coefficients`.

Q125 — Linear Coefficients Access

How are coefficients accessed for a linear regression model?

A. `model.coefficients`.
B. `model.featureImportances`.
C. `model.intercept` only.
D. `model.summary` only.

A125 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q126 — Decision Tree Classifier

Which class trains a decision tree classifier?

A. `DecisionTreeClassifier`.
B. `LinearRegression`.
C. `LogisticRegression`.
D. `KMeans`.

A126 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q127 — Random Forest Classifier

Which class trains a random forest classifier?

A. `RandomForestClassifier`.
B. `DecisionTreeRegressor`.
C. `LinearSVC`.
D. `NaiveBayes`.

A127 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q128 — Gradient-Boosted Trees

Which class trains a gradient-boosted tree classifier?

A. `GBTClassifier`.

B. `RandomForestClassifier`.

C. `DecisionTreeClassifier`.

D. `LogisticRegression`.

A128 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q129 — KMeans Clustering

Which class performs k-means clustering?

A. `KMeans`.
B. `LogisticRegression`.
C. `LinearRegression`.
D. `RandomForestClassifier`.

A129 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q130 — VectorAssembler Input Types

Which column types can `VectorAssembler` accept?

A. Numeric, boolean, and vector columns.
B. Only string columns.
C. Only categorical columns.
D. Only binary columns.

A130 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q131 — MinMaxScaler Default Range

Default output range of `MinMaxScaler`?

A. $[0, 1]$.
B. $[-1, 1]$.
C. $[0, 100]$.
D. Mean 0, variance 1.

A131 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`MinMaxScaler(min=0.0, max=1.0)` is the default.

Q132 — StandardScaler Parameters

Which parameters does `StandardScaler` compute during fit?

A. Mean and standard deviation.

B. Minimum and maximum.

C. Median and IQR.

D. Mode and variance.

A132 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q133 — Imputer Supported Strategies

Which strategies does Spark ML `Imputer` support?

A. Mean, median, mode.

B. Only mean.

C. Only zero.

D. Only median.

A133 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q134 — FeatureHasher Purpose

What does `FeatureHasher` do?

A. Hashes categorical features into a fixed-length vector without a vocabulary.
B. Imputes missing values.
C. Scales features.
D. Splits data.

A134 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Constant memory; possible hash collisions.

Q135 — SQLTransformer Purpose

What does `SQLTransformer` do in a pipeline?

A. Applies a SQL expression to transform the DataFrame.
B. Trains a model.
C. Evaluates a model.
D. Deploys a model.

A135 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q136 — VectorSlicer Purpose

What does `VectorSlicer` do?

A. Selects a subset of features from a vector column.
B. Combines columns into a vector.
C. Scales features.
D. Imputes missing values.

A136 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q137 — PolynomialExpansion Purpose

What does `PolynomialExpansion` do?

A. Generates polynomial and interaction features.
B. Encodes categorical features.
C. Scales features.
D. Splits data.

A137 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q138 — Binarizer Purpose

What does `Binarizer` do?

A. Thresholds a continuous feature into a binary feature.
B. Encodes categorical features.
C. Scales features.
D. Imputes missing values.

A138 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q139 — CV numFolds Meaning

What does `numFolds` control in `CrossValidator`?

A. Number of k folds.
B. Number of models to deploy.
C. Number of features to select.
D. Number of clusters.

A139 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q140 — trainRatio Meaning

What does `trainRatio` control in `TrainValidationSplit`?

A. Fraction of data used for training.
B. Number of folds.
C. Number of trials.
D. Learning rate.

A140 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q141 — Binary Metric

Which metric belongs to `BinaryClassificationEvaluator`?

A. Area under ROC.
B. RMSE.
C. MAE.
D. R^2.

A141 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q142 — Regression Metric

Which metric belongs to `RegressionEvaluator`?

A. RMSE.
B. Precision.
C. Recall.
D. F1.

A142 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q143 — Multiclass Metric

Which metric belongs to `MulticlassClassificationEvaluator`?

A. F1.

B. RMSE.

C. MAE.

D. R^2.

A143 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q144 — Pipeline Fit Output

Fitting a `Pipeline` produces what?

A. `PipelineModel`.
B. A raw DataFrame.
C. A cluster.
D. An MLflow experiment.

A144 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q145 — Spark ML Save Format

What format does Spark ML use to save a model?

A. A directory containing metadata and Parquet files.
B. A single CSV file.
C. A pickle file only.
D. A JSON file only.

A145 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q146 — MLflow Model Flavor Definition

What is an MLflow model flavor?

A. A convention for saving/loading models from different libraries.

B. A cluster type.

C. A visualization tool.

D. A data source.

A146 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q147 — Model Signature Purpose

What is the purpose of a model signature?

A. Defines expected input/output schema.
B. Encrypts the model.
C. Compresses the model.
D. Deletes the model.

A147 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q148 — StringIndexer handleInvalid Default

Default behavior for unseen label at transform time?

A. Throws an error unless `handleInvalid` is set.
B. Silently ignores the row.
C. Maps to index 0.
D. Maps to the most frequent label.

A148 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q149 — OneHotEncoder Input Type

What input does `OneHotEncoder` expect?

A. A numeric index column (typically from `StringIndexer`).
B. A raw string column.
C. A continuous feature.
D. A vector column.

A149 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q150 — Hyperopt Search Space Loguniform

Which expression defines a log-uniform distribution?

A. `hp.loguniform('x', low, high)`.

B. `hp.uniform('x', low, high)`.

C. `hp.choice('x', [a,b])`.

D. `hp.quniform('x', low, high, q)`.

Correct: A.

Useful for learning rates and regularization strengths.

Q151 — Delta Lake for ML

Why is Delta Lake often used for ML training data?

A. ACID transactions, time travel, and schema enforcement.
B. Only for streaming.
C. Only for images.
D. It replaces MLflow.

Correct: A.

Time travel enables reproducible training sets.

Q152 — Delta Time Travel

Which clause queries a Delta table's historical version?

A. `VERSION AS OF` / `TIMESTAMP AS OF`.

B. `WHERE version=`.

C. `SELECT history`.

D. `UNDROP`.

A152 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q153 — Workflow Job for ML

A recurring training job should run nightly on a schedule. What Databricks feature?

A. A notebook opened manually.
B. Databricks Workflows job with a schedule.
C. A dashboard.
D. A cluster event log.

Correct: B.

Workflows schedules notebooks/jobs and manages retries and alerts.

Q154 — Job Cluster vs All-Purpose

Why use a job cluster for scheduled training?

A. Cheaper: cluster terminates after the job.
B. Always more expensive.
C. It has no compute.
D. It is shared with all users.

A154 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Job clusters are ephemeral and cost-efficient for scheduled workloads.

Q155 — mlflow.start_run nesting

What argument nests a child run inside a parent run?

A. `nested=True`.

B. `parent=run_id`.

C. `child=True`.

D. `tag="child"`.

A155 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

`mlflow.start_run(nested=True)` creates a child run.

Q156 — MLflow Active Run

How is the currently active run retrieved?

A. `mlflow.active_run()`.

B. `mlflow.start_run()`.

C. `mlflow.get_run()`.

D. `mlflow.end_run()`.

A156 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q157 — MLflow Tracking URI

How is a custom tracking URI set?

A. `mlflow.set_tracking_uri()`.

B. `mlflow.set_experiment()`.

C. `mlflow.log_param()`.

D. `spark.conf.set()`.

A157 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q158 — Summary Statistics Command

Which command computes summary statistics on a Spark DataFrame?

A. `df.summary()`.

B. `df.show()`.

C. `df.printSchema()`.

D. `df.count()`.

A158 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q159 — Describe Command

Which command gives count/mean/std/min/max?

A. `df.describe()`.

B. `df.show()`.

C. `df.columns`.

D. `df.dtypes`.

A159 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q160 — IQR Rule

What is the IQR outlier rule?

A. Remove below Q1 or above Q3.
B. Remove below $Q1 - 1.5\,IQR$ or above $Q3 + 1.5\,IQR$.
C. Remove beyond mean.
D. Remove $z > 1$.

A160 — Answer: B

Correct: B.

Q161 — Z-Score Meaning

What does a z-score represent?

A. Number of standard deviations from the mean.
B. The median.
C. The mode.
D. The variance.

A161 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q162 — Pandas API Conversion

How is a Spark DataFrame converted to pandas API on Spark?

A. `spark_df.pandas_api`.
B. `spark_df.to_pandas()`.
C. `spark_df.collect()`.
D. `spark_df.rdd`.

A162 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q163 — toPandas Behavior

What does `toPandas()` do?

A. Collects the DataFrame to local pandas on the driver.
B. Converts to pandas API on Spark.
C. Saves to disk.
D. Deletes the DataFrame.

Correct: A.

Warning: collects all rows to driver memory.

Q164 — Crosstab Output

What does `df.crosstab()` produce?

A. A contingency table between two categorical columns.

B. A scatter plot.

C. A correlation matrix.

D. A histogram.

A164 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q165 — dropna Command

Which method drops rows with nulls?

A. `df.dropna()`.

B. `df.fillna()`.

C. `df.replace()`.

D. `df.filter()`.

A165 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q166 — fillna Command

Which method fills nulls with a value?

A. `df.fillna()`.

B. `df.dropna()`.

C. `df.replace()`.

D. `df.filter()`.

A166 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q167 — GroupBy Mean

Which computes a mean after grouping?

A. `df.groupBy('col').mean()`.

B. `df.mean('col')`.

C. `df.agg('mean')`.

D. `df.summary()`.

A167 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q168 — Spark SQL Usage

How can a Spark DataFrame be queried with SQL?

A. Register as temp view and use `spark.sql()`.
B. Convert to pandas only.
C. Use `df.show()` only.
D. Use `df.printSchema()` only.

A168 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q169 — Join Type

Which join returns all left rows and matching right rows?

A. Left join.
B. Inner join.
C. Right join.
D. Full outer join.

A169 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q170 — dropDuplicates

Which method removes duplicate rows?

A. `df.dropDuplicates()`.

B. `df.distinct()`.

C. `df.dropna()`.

D. `df.filter()`.

Correct: A.

Both `dropDuplicates()` and `distinct()` remove duplicates; `dropDuplicates()` can take subset columns.

Q171 — Summary on Numeric

Which command provides quartiles in summary statistics?

A. `df.summary("quartiles")`.

B. `df.describe()`.

C. `df.count()`.

D. `df.show()`.

A171 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q172 — Missing Value Count

Which approach counts nulls per column?

A. `df.select([count(when(col(c).isNull(), c)).alias(c) for c in df.columns])`.

B. `df.count()`.

C. `df.describe()`.

D. `df.show()`.

A172 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q173 — Histogram Purpose

What does a histogram show?

A. Distribution of a single continuous feature.
B. Relationship between two categorical features.
C. Model coefficients.
D. Confusion matrix.

A173 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q174 — Box Plot Purpose

What does a box plot show?

A. Distribution with quartiles and outliers.
B. Correlation between two categoricals.
C. Exact values of all points.
D. Confusion matrix.

A174 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q175 — Correlation Matrix

What does a correlation matrix show?

A. Pairwise correlations between numeric features.
B. Distribution of a single feature.
C. Model accuracy.
D. Number of missing values.

A175 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q176 — Serving Endpoint REST Call

How is a deployed endpoint called from an application?

A. HTTP REST call with Databricks auth.
B. Direct DBFS read.
C. Notebook execution.
D. SQL only.

A176 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q177 — Endpoint Payload Format

What format does a serving endpoint accept for input?

A. JSON records, optionally Pandas-split or dataframe-records format.
B. CSV only.
C. Pickle file.
D. Excel workbook.

A177 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q178 — Inference Table Purpose

What does an inference table enable?

A. Monitoring and retraining from production logs.
B. Faster training.
C. Cheaper storage.
D. Automatic feature engineering.

A178 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q179 — Model Serving Version Update

How is a new model version rolled out without downtime?

A. Update endpoint config; serving rolls over.
B. Stop endpoint, then create new.
C. Manually copy files.
D. Delete all other versions.

A179 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q180 — Serving Endpoint Alias Use

Why configure an endpoint to serve `@champion`?

A. Alias moves automatically when promoted; no endpoint config change needed.
B. Alias is immutable.
C. Alias disables logging.
D. Alias prevents autoscaling.

A180 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q181 — Feature Serving Endpoint

What does a Feature Serving endpoint do?

A. Serves feature lookups via REST for real-time inference.
B. Trains models.
C. Registers models.
D. Deletes experiments.

A181 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q182 — Endpoint Scaling

What does scale-to-zero do?

A. Scales endpoint to zero replicas when idle, then scales up on demand.
B. Always keeps one replica.
C. Removes the endpoint.
D. Increases throughput.

A182 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q183 — Serving Endpoint Auth

Which auth mechanism is recommended for production automated calls?

A. OAuth machine-to-machine (M2M) or PAT.

B. Basic username/password.

C. Anonymous.

D. Cluster token.

A183 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q184 — Batch Inference Job

How can a large scoring job be scheduled on Databricks?

A. Databricks Workflows job running batch scoring notebook.
B. Manual notebook runs.
C. Endpoint only.
D. Dashboard.

A184 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q185 — Endpoint Permissions

Which permission allows querying an endpoint?

A. `CAN QUERY`.

B. `MANAGE`.

C. `SELECT`.

D. `EXECUTE`.

A185 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q186 — Monitoring Metric

Which metric is key for monitoring a classifier over time?

A. Prediction distribution and drift.
B. Only training accuracy.
C. Cluster CPU.
D. Notebook revision count.

A186 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q187 — Model Retraining Trigger

What commonly triggers model retraining?

A. Performance drift or new labeled data.
B. Cluster idle time.
C. Storage growth.
D. Notebook save.

A187 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q188 — Serving Latency

Which factor most affects real-time endpoint latency?

A. Model size and provisioned capacity.
B. Number of notebooks.
C. Dataset size at training.
D. Cluster event logs.

A188 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q189 — Model Serving Rollback

How can a bad deployment be rolled back?

A. Point the endpoint back to the prior version or alias.
B. Retrain the model.
C. Delete the endpoint.
D. Drop the schema.

A189 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q190 — Serving Endpoint Health

Which endpoint status indicates it is active?

A. `Ready`.
B. `Pending`.
C. `Failed`.
D. `Deleted`.

A190 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q191 — Autolog vs Manual

A data scientist wants both autolog and custom metrics. What is correct?

A. Can combine autolog with explicit `log_metric` calls.
B. Autolog blocks all custom logging.
C. Custom metrics overwrite autolog.
D. Only autolog allowed.

A191 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q192 — Nested Run Comparison

Which UI view is best for comparing hyperparameter trials?

A. The parent run's child runs table/chart.

B. Cluster logs.

C. Notebook output.

D. Dashboard only.

A192 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q193 — Feature Store Update Pattern

How are new features added to an existing feature table?

A. Write a new DataFrame via `write_table()` with merge mode.
B. Delete and recreate.
C. Edit Parquet files manually.
D. Drop table.

A193 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q194 — Alias Best Practice

Why move `@champion` rather than edit endpoint config?

A. Single source of truth for production version; consumers stay unchanged.

B. Alias is faster.

C. Alias is required by Spark.

D. Alias avoids logging.

A194 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q195 — Signature Inference

Which function infers a model signature from training data?

A. `mlflow.models.infer_signature()`.

B. `mlflow.log_model()`.

C. `mlflow.start_run()`.

D. `mlflow.set_tag()`.

A195 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q196 — Feature Store Entity

What identifies a feature table entity?

A. Primary keys.
B. Timestamp keys.
C. Model version.
D. Cluster ID.

A196 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q197 — Serving Endpoint Model Size

What limits the size of a model deployed to Model Serving?

A. Platform size limits and memory per replica.
B. Only the notebook.
C. The cluster event log.
D. The number of features.

A197 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q198 — MLflow Artifact URI

Which URI references a run artifact?

A. `runs:/<run_id>/<path>`.

B. `models:/name/version`.

C. `artifacts:/path`.

D. `file:///`.

A198 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q199 — Registry Best Practice

Why register models instead of shipping pickle files?

A. Versioning, lineage, aliases, and access control.

B. Faster training.

C. Smaller artifacts.

D. Automatic feature engineering.

A199 — Answer: A

Correct: A.

Q200 — Exam Review Checklist

Which is the **least** likely to be tested on the Databricks ML Associate exam?

A. MLflow experiment tracking.
B. Unity Catalog model registry.
C. Feature Store for training-serving consistency.
D. Deep math derivations of SVM dual form.

Correct: D.

Exam focuses on Databricks tooling and workflows, not theoretical derivations.

Final Tips

Domains: Databricks ML (38%), Model Development (31%), ML Workflows (19%), Deployment (12%).

Master tool names and API calls: `mlflow.*`, `fe.*`, `SparkTrials`, `CrossValidator`.

Know the "why": UC registry (governance), Feature Store (skew), serving (scale-to-zero).

Watch for "Select two/three" and "least likely" traps.